

Question 11 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

State any two objectives of Human Resource Development.

Introduction

The wording ‘state any two’ looks like a short question, but in this question bank every item is treated as an 8-mark theoretical answer. Therefore you must not write two one-line sentences and stop. You should (a) name two main objectives clearly, (b) explain the meaning of each in simple language, (c) give a workplace example, and (d) show how HRD tries to achieve that objective. After that, add a short paragraph on other important objectives so the examiner sees that you know the full concept.

The safest source is Prof. T.V. Rao’s definition. He said HRD is a process by which employees of an organisation are helped, in a continuous and planned way, to: acquire or sharpen capabilities for present or expected future roles; develop their general capabilities as individuals and discover inner potential; and develop an organisational culture of teamwork and collaboration. Leonard Nadler’s idea of organised learning for behavioural change also supports these objectives.

A beginner should remember: an objective is not a training topic. An objective is a purpose — why the organisation does HRD at all.

Detailed points

1. First objective — capabilities for present and future roles. The first objective you should write is: to help employees acquire or sharpen the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to perform their present job and the job they may be asked to do later. ‘Acquire’ means learning something new (a new software, a new machine, a new law). ‘Sharpen’ means improving what is already partly known (a salesman who can sell, but must learn to sell a more complex product). This objective exists because work does not stay frozen. Technology, customers and quality standards change. If HRD only looks at today’s task, people become outdated and performance falls. Example: a bank clerk who only knows paper ledgers cannot serve customers when the branch is computerised, unless HRD has already planned computer training. So this objective protects both the employee’s usefulness and the organisation’s service.

2. How this first objective is achieved. HRD achieves it through induction, job training, coaching by the supervisor, job rotation, e-learning and refresher courses. Performance appraisal is used to find which capability is weak. Training Needs Assessment decides whether the gap is really a skill gap. The point to write in the exam is: this objective is continuous, not a one-day induction. Capabilities become blunt; they must be resharpened. That is why T.V. Rao used the words ‘continuous and planned way’.

3. Second objective — develop general capabilities and inner potential. The second objective is: to help individuals develop as whole persons and discover inner potential for their own growth and for organisational development. This is wider than the present job. General capabilities include communication, problem-solving, judgement, learning how to learn, integrity and teamwork. Inner potential means talents the person (and even the boss) may not have noticed — for example a quiet technician who is excellent at analysing process waste. If HRD ignores this objective, the organisation uses only a fraction of the human being it is already paying. Example: a nurse with calm leadership ability may never become a ward in-charge unless potential is noticed and developed.

4. How this second objective is achieved. Potential appraisal, career planning, education (not only job training), mentoring, stretch assignments and counselling are the tools. Development here is often longer-term and partly depends on the person’s own ambition, but the organisation must provide opportunity and guidance. Notes also say development of the person as an individual is a stated goal of the HRD system, separate from ‘capabilities in the present role’.

5. You may present culture as a closely related third objective. T.V. Rao's third pillar is to develop a culture in which superior-subordinate relationships, teamwork and collaboration among units are strong, contributing to professional well-being, motivation and pride. Even if the question asks for two objectives, writing five to eight lines on culture shows complete understanding. Without this culture, the first two objectives fail because people will not share knowledge or admit skill gaps.

6. Other objectives from the notes — equity, employability, adaptability. Equity means every employee gets a fair chance of training, promotion and quality of work life irrespective of caste, creed, religion, language or gender. Employability means HRD improves skills so that the person can seek gainful work and remain valuable. Adaptability means continuous training so that employees can adjust to organisational change. These three make HRD socially responsible, not only profit-oriented. You can mention them as additional objectives after your two main ones.

7. Multi-level objectives of the HRD system. The notes list seven system goals: capabilities of each employee as an individual; in the present role; in expected future roles; the dyadic relationship with the supervisor; team spirit in every unit; collaboration among units; and the organisation's overall health and self-renewing capability. This list is useful because it proves HRD is not 'send staff to a course'. If you have time, write two sentences from this list after your two main objectives.

8. How to write this in the answer book (8 marks). Give a 6–8 line introduction (Nadler + Rao). Then heading: Objective 1 — explain + example + how achieved (about half a page). Heading: Objective 2 — same. Then a short paragraph 'Other important objectives'. Conclusion of 4 lines. Never submit two sentences only; that cannot score 8 marks even if the two names are correct.

Conclusion. *The two strongest objectives to name are (1) acquiring and sharpening capabilities for present and future roles, and (2) developing general capabilities, inner potential and a collaborative culture. Explain each with meaning, example and HRD mechanisms. Close by saying HRD's purpose is growth of people and of the organisation together, in a continuous planned process, not a single training event.*